Eunji Woo, Ph.D.

Daejeon, Republic of Korea · +82 10 5358 4865 · eunji.woo@kaist.ac.kr · linkedin.com/in/ooungy

RESEARCH STATEMENT

My research examines how local actors function as "diffuse designers" in shaping community life through situated, creative action. I extend this framework by developing design methods, tools, and policy models that translate tacit local practices into structured and scalable forms. Through collaborative field-based research, I work directly with communities to co-develop and validate these approaches in practice. This work demonstrates how design can support bottom-up innovation while preserving human agency in increasingly optimized socio-technical systems.

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Industrial Design, KAIST. Daejeon, Korea — Sep 2019 - Aug 2025
- Thesis title: *Designing Community-Anchored Customer Experiences for Local Shops: with a Focus on Design Process, Technology Mediation, Design Facilitation, and Policy Support*
- Advisors: Ki-Young Nam, Sangsu Lee, Hwajung Hong (KAIST); Yoori Koo (Hongik University); Jongryn Mo (Yonsei University)

M.S. Industrial Design, KAIST. Daejeon, Korea — Sep 2017 - Aug 2019
- Thesis: *Typology of Local Knowledge Handlers and Merchants' Roles for Community Design*
- Advisors: Ki-Young Nam, Sangsu Lee, Tek-Jin Nam (KAIST)

Exchange Student, RMIT University. Melbourne, Australia — Sep 2013 - Dec 2013

B.S. Industrial Design, KAIST. Daejeon, Korea — Feb 2009 - Feb 2015

Gyeongbuk Science High School. Pohang, Korea — Mar 2007 - Feb 2009

EMPLOYMENT

Postdoctoral Fellow. Dept. of Industrial Design, KAIST. — Sep 2025 - Present
- Research Title: *Generative AI–Based Prototyping Tool for Service Experiences (Co-located Social Interaction Experiments with AI Urban Creators)*

Part-time Lecturer. Dept. of Culture and Design Management, Underwood International College, Yonsei University. Incheon, Korea — Jan 2025 - Present

Visiting Researcher. DLX Design Lab, University of Tokyo — Jan 2026 - Feb 2026
- Lab Director: Prof. Ki-Young Nam

Research Fellow. Daejeon Sejong Research Institute. Daejeon, Korea — Jul 2025 - Sep 2025
- Project Title: *Local Branding Linkers for Regional Identity*
- Principal Investigator: Dr. Hyejin Joo

Researcher. Designize DESIS Lab, Dept. of Industrial Design, KAIST. — Sep 2017 - Aug 2025
- Lab Director: Prof. Miles Pennington

Academic Tutor. Korea National Open University. — Fall 2023, 2024, 2025
- Course Instructor: Prof. Yujin Kim (Kongju University)

UX Researcher. Beyond Lab, Golfzon. Daejeon, Korea — Jan 2015 - Jun 2017

Internship. Satyendra Pakhalé Design Studio. Amsterdam, Netherlands Feb 2014 - May 2014

PUBLICATIONS

Books

Eunji Woo & Ki-Young Nam. (under contract). *Designing Community-Anchored Experiences for Local Shops*. Springer. (Monograph)

Journal Articles

Eunji Woo & Ki-Young Nam. (2025). Touchpoint Design for Local Shops as a Community Hub. *International Journal of Design*. [SCI-E, SSCI, A&HCI, Scopus] 10.57698/v19i3.03

Chorong Kim, **Eunji Woo,** Hanjong Kim, & Ki-Young Nam. (forthcoming). Fear-free and Gamified Engagement Platform Design for Local Community-Building. *Digital Creativity*. [Scopus, AHCI] 10.57698/v19i3.03

Chorong Kim, Jini Kim, & **Eunji Woo.** (2024). Probe Study of Resource Exchange Service in Local Community: with focus. *Archives of Design Research,* 37(1):245-257. *(in Korean)* [KCI] Selected for **Excellent Award.** 10.15187/adr.2024.02.37.1.245

Minseo Park, Hyewon Yang, Jeonghoon Han, **Eunji Woo,** & Ki-Young Nam (2023). Collaboration Service Design Strategies for Local Shops. *Journal of the Korean Society of Design Culture*, vol.29, no.4, pp. 137-151. *(in Korean)* [KCI] 10.18208/ksdc.2023.29.4.137

Chorong Kim, **Eunji Woo,** & Ki-Young Nam. (2023). Shy Attendee, Lone Whiner, and I-Don't-Carer: Three Target Groups for Co-design Approaches to Public Policy Agenda Setting. *Design Works,* 5(4):2-15. [KCI] 10.15187/dw.2022.12.5.4.2

Conference Proceedings

Eunji Woo (2025). Designing community-anchored customer experiences for local shops. Selected doctoral consortium presentation at the *International Association of Societies of Design Research*.

Yedam Ryu, **Eunji Woo,** Seoju Yoon & Ki-Young Nam (2025). Look Who's Quarrelling: How Role-Playing Can Address Social Conflicts in Local Shop Commons. *In the Proceedings of the International Association for Societies of Design Research*.

Eunji Woo (2025). Hackathon as Relational Catalyst: Designing Social Interaction between Local Shops and Customers. *In the Proceedings of KSDS Fall International Conference*.

Haewon Shin, Yadi Fu, Yumin Kim, & **Eunji Woo** (2025). UniRide: Designing for Social and Emotional Dimensions of Campus Mobility. *In the Proceedings of KSDS Fall International Conference*.

Eunji Woo, Chorong Kim, Hyejin Kwon, Yedam Ryu, Youngok Choi, & Ki-Young Nam (2023). Meet Me at the Local Shop: Designing Community Anchors for Customer Engagement. *In the Proceedings of the International Association for Societies of Design Research*.

Yedam Ryu, Chorong Kim, **Eunji Woo,** & Ki-Young Nam (2023). Why Design Matters in Local Business Commoning. *In the Proceedings of the International Association for Societies of Design Research*.

Eunji Woo & Ki-Young Nam (2020, August). Punter's Secret: Why Millennials Love That Local

Shop?, *In the Proceedings of 22st DMI: Academic Design Management Conference.*

Eunji Woo, Chorong Kim, & Ki-Young Nam (2019, June). The Journey of Local Knowledge Toward Designing Neighborhood Regeneration, *In Academy for Design Innovation Management 2019, Research: Perspectives In the Era of Transformations*. Academy for Design Innovation Management. http://hdl.handle.net/10203/263905

Juhee Kim, **Eunji Woo,** Hoi San Wu, & Ki-Young Nam (2019, September). Adapting Service Design Thinking to Local Festivals, *In the Proceedings of the International Association for Societies of Design Research.*

Chorong Kim, **Eunji Woo** & Ki-Young Nam. (2018, August). Designing Engagement for Local Public Policy Development, *In the Proceedings of Academic Design Management Conference.*

Workshops

Yedam Ryu, **Eunji Woo,** & Ki-Young Nam (2024). Playing Out Conflicts for Harmony: Co-Designing Rules for Running Local Businesses with the Community. *In 2024 Design Research Society (DRS) Conference.*

Professional Publications

Eunji Woo & Ki-Young Nam. (2024, June). Personifying Local Shops with Community Vision, *Design Management Review*, 35(2):4-13. 10.1111/drev.12392

Eunji Woo & Ki-Young Nam. (2021, August). Designing Community-Based Local Shopping Experiences, *Design Management Review*, 32(3):38-43, 10.1111/drev.12270

Chorong Kim, **Eunji Woo** & Ki-Young Nam. (2019, September). The Paradox of the Excluded Majority in Youth Policy Design, *Design Management Review*, 30(3):14-21, 10.1111/drev.12184

Eunji Woo. (2023). Community Design for Relationship-Building and Local Transformation (관계를 만들고 지역을 바꾸는 커뮤니티 디자인). *Live Like a Local*, Issue 2. *(in Korean)* [Government publication, published by the Sejong Center for Creative Economy & Innovation, under Korea's Ministry of SMEs and Startups]

RESEARCH GRANTS

Jang Young Sil Fellow Program, Postdoctoral Researcher Track — Sep, 2025 - Aug, 2026
- Funded by KAIST Office of Research Affairs
- 50,000,000 KRW (equivalent to 36,500 USD)

PROJECTS

Lab Projects (Designize Lab, KAIST)

Hyperlocal Revitalization Project in Eoeundong (슬기로운동네생활) — 2024-2026
- Commissioned by the Ministry of Public Administration and Security

Impact Framework Design for Community Activities in Youth Village ("Yeogirang", Daejeon) — Jan. - Mar. 2025
- Led the project as a *Project Manager*
- Commissioned by Daejeon Metropolitan City Hall, Daejeon City

Vision Framework Planning for the KAIST Global Internship Program (Silicon Valley) — Feb. - Mar. 2025
- Led the project as a *Project Manager*
- Commissioned by Startup KAIST

Archiving Daejeon's Design Legacy: Protocol Development Sep. - Dec. 2024
- Led the project as a *Project Manager*
- Commissioned by Daejeon Institute of Design Promotion

Speculative Design Intervention for Innovative Local Shops Exploring Community-Anchored Customer Experiences 2022
- Led the project as a *Project Manager*
- Collaborated with the Design School at Brunel University London
- Selected for Global Initiative Research Collaboration Program by College of Engineering, KAIST

Policy Blueprint Design to Support Young Single-Person Households in Daejeon 2021
- Commissioned by Daejeon Metropolitan City Hall, Daejeon City

Startup Support Program Design for Youth–Microenterprise Collaboration in Urban Regeneration (Oh-jeong-dong, Daejeon) Jan. - Jun. 2020
- Led the project as a *Project Manager*
- Commissioned by the Daedeok District Office, Dajeon City

Research-Practice Initiatives

The "Church Dilemma" Conference: Reframing the Role of Churches in Local Communities 2025
- Curated and organized a three-day community conference, focusing on the role of churches as neighborhood-based actors in local care and relationship-building.
- Recruited and programmed three speakers who were both practicing Christians and community-oriented professionals, facilitating discussions on faith-based engagement from a local perspective.
- Engaged approximately 50 participants over three days and raised KRW 1,000,000, which was donated to a local child welfare center.

Nerd Stool Project: Designing Stools Capturing Daejeon's Scientific Identity 2023
- Planned and led the project as project manager, designing and facilitating a cross-sector collaboration among 10 university students, 5 local researchers, a woodworking team, and local media.
- Selected for the Local Branding and Experimental Design Support Program by the Daejeon Center for Social Innovation.

Metaphoric Forest: A Prototype Offline Platform for Building a Local Community in Yuseong-gu 2023
- Experimented with the model in Yuseong-gu, Daejeon, through a six-month pop-up independent bookstore, serving as a prototype for connecting local stakeholders through knowledge-based content.
- Selected for the Local Creator Support Program by the Ministry of SMEs and Startups, Korea.

Make Local Better Hackathon: A Problem-Solving Workshop for Local Shops and Regulars 2023
- Planned and led the project as project manager, designing and facilitating a cross-sector collaboration involving 5 local shop owners and 20 regular customers.
- Selected for funding by the Regional Innovation Center, Chungnam National University, Daejeon, Korea.

Time Traveler's Diary: A Speculative Vision Workshop for the Jeminchun Commercial District (Gongju, Korea) 2023

- Designed and led a street-based speculative design workshop to engage residents, visitors, and short-term dwellers in envisioning future scenarios for the neighborhood.
- Developed a vision including 10 place-based themes and built an online exhibition to archive the outputs.
- Commissioned by Puzzle Lab, a local area management agency in Gongju, Korea.

TEACHING

University Teaching (KAIST)

[ID966] Catch the Future Seminar Spring 2026

University Teaching (Yonsei University)

[CDM4008] Social Innovation for Sustainability Fall 2025, 2026

[CDM3001] Service Design Spring 2025, 2026

- Guided undergraduate students through local service innovation projects, including user interviews, qualitative analysis, persona development, journey mapping, and scenario building.
- Received a **student evaluation score of 4.54 / 5.00**, exceeding the department average (4.25)

External Teaching (Public Program)

Community Design for Commercial District Revitalization Oct 2023 - Nov 2023

- Delivered a 10-hour intensive course for senior professionals (10+ years' experience)
- Covered community design case studies, roles of local merchants, and frameworks for building community-centered districts
- Part of a national training program hosted by Small Enterprise and Market Service, under the Ministry of SMEs and Startups, Korea

Research Supervision

Undergraduate Research Program, KAIST Spring 2023

- Research title: *Designing Needs-Based Service Programs for Independent Bookshops*
- Supervised undergraduate team in planning and conducting an independent research project

Undergraduate Research Program, KAIST Spring 2022

- Research title: *Designing a Recommender Platform for Local Shop Collaboration*
- Supervised undergraduate team in planning and conducting an independent research project
- Selected for **Excellent Research Award**

Teaching Assistant (KAIST)

[CD401] Multidisciplinary Capstone Design I, II 2021-2022 (three terms)

- Dept. of Entrepreneurship, KAIST (Instructor: Prof. Jaemin Koo)

[KEI560] Design Thinking for Startup Fall 2020
- Dept. of Entrepreneurship, KAIST (Instructor: Prof. Jaemin Koo)

[ID212] Basic Design Spring 2022
- Dept. of Industrial Design, KAIST (Instructor: Prof. Ki-Young Nam)

[ID201] Introduction to Industrial Design Spring 2020
- Dept. of Industrial Design, KAIST (Instructor: Prof. Hyunjung Kim)

[ID203] Product Design Spring 2019
- Dept. of Industrial Design, KAIST (Instructor: Prof. Sangmin Bae)

[HSS258] Geography of International Development Fall 2018
- School of Humanities, KAIST (Instructor: Prof. Seung-Ook Lee)

Teaching Assistant (Korea National Open University)

Digital Marketing Design Fall 2023, 2024, 2025
- Instructor: Prof. Yujin Kim (Kongju University)

INVITED TALKS

Academic & University Talks

경희대 특강
도쿄대
KIT (교토)
무사시노대

Guest Speaker, *"Local Community Design",* in Entrepreneurship & Startup Strategy. Keimyung University, Korea. Nov 18, 2025

Guest Speaker, *"Designing with Local Community: Resources, Capabilities, and Practices,* Hallym-Thammasat University International Workshop. Hallym University, Korea. Nov 02, 2025

Guest Speaker, *"Designing Social Innovation from Neighborhood",* Digital Arts & Humanities Colloquium. Hallym University, Korea. Apr 29, 2025

Guest Speaker, *"Design for My Neighborhood",* York University, Canada. Mar 12, 2025

Guest Speaker, *"AI-based Double Diamond Design Process",* Korea National Open University, Korea Dec 03, 2024

Guest Speaker, *"Designing Social Innovation from Neighborhood"*, Dept. of Culture and Design Management. Yonsei University, Korea. May 14, 2024

Guest Speaker, *"Designing Community Anchors for Customer Engagement"*, SIG Symposium, Korean Society of Design Science Fall International Conference. Oct 04, 2023

Guest Speaker, *"Speculative Design for Community-based Customer Experiences in Local Shops"*, Dept. of Industrial Design, KAIST, Korea May 16, 2023

Guest Speaker, *"Speculative Design for Local Shops",* Design School, Brunel University, U.K. Dec 09, 2022

Guest Speaker, *"Design Thinking for My Neighborhood"*, Dept. of Public Administration, Daejeon University, Korea Oct 10, 2018

Public / Industry / Community Talks

Invited Speaker, Local Meetup at the Local Brand Forum, Gangneung, Korea — Sep 05, 2025

Panelist, Expert Roundtable for the Book *Creator Society* by Prof. Jongryn Mo, Hosted by Portland School, Seoul, Korea — Nov 07, 2024
- Co-panelists included Prof. Byung-Il Choi (Trade Policy Expert, Ewha Womans Univ.) and Dr. Sookyung Jung (Urban Planner, Joyful City Lab)

Invited Speaker, *"Community-building Practices in Daejeon"*, Daejeon Shaping Forum, Global Shapers Community, Daejeon, Korea — Nov 23, 2023

Invited Lecturer, *"How Local Shops Design Everyday Lifestyle"*, Local Branding Course at Chungwon High School, Chungju, Korea — Nov 11, 2023

Invited Speaker, *"How Urban Data Shapes the Future of Local Communities"*, Daejeon Sejong Research Institute, Daejeon, Korea — Oct 30, 2023

Invited Lecturer, *"Community Designing"*, KOICA Rwanda Farmers Training Program at Canaan Farmers School, Wonju, Korea — Jul 26, 2023

Panelist, Expert Roundtable at the 2nd Eoeun-Gungdong Innovation Ecosystem Forum, Hosted by Yuseong District Office, Daejeon, Korea — Jul 25, 2023
- Co-panelists included Cheongsu Lee (Deputy Director, Ministry of SMEs and StartUps), and Youngju Ko (President, Daejeon Institute of Science & Technology for Enterprise & People)

Panelist, Regional Startup Ecosystem Panel Talk, Hosted by D.Camp, Jeju, Korea — Jul 19, 2023
- Co-panelists included Jeonghwan Jun (Former Director of Jeju Center for Creative Economy and Innovation), and Prof. Woojin Lee (Kookmin Univ.)

Invited Lecturer, *"Making It through Community Life in Daejeon"*, Youth Community Activity Program at Daejeon Youth Center, Daejeon, Korea — Jun 28, 2023

Invited Lecturer, *"Neighborhood as a Community of Creativity and Inspiration"*, the 1st Eoeun-Gungdong Innovation Ecosystem Forum, Hosted by Yuseong District Office, Daejeon, Korea — Jun 15, 2023

Invited Lecturer, *"Service Design for Community-Building in Local Shops"*, LINC 3.0 Program at Chosun University, Gwangju, Korea — Jan 30, 2023

Organizer & Host, *"Soreum-Dongne Forum"*, Cross-Disciplinary Conversations on Neighborhoods — Jan 29, 2023
- Co-organized with Danggeun Market (당근마켓)
- Brought together 4 Karrot team members and 4 local practitioners

Invited Lecturer, *"Design Strategies for Community-Based Customer Experience in Local Shops",* In-house Seminar at Danggeun Market (당근마켓), Seoul, Korea — Dec 09, 2022

Invited Lecturer, *"Service Design for Local Creators"*, Balanced Development Information & Cooperation Forum, hosted by the Presidential Committee for Balanced National Development, Jeju, Korea — Oct 08, 2020

Invited Lecturer, *"Designing Mutual Relationships between Local Shops and Communities"*, Bee-Startup Local Entrepreneurship Incubating Academy, Daejeon, Korea — Apr, 2019

Invited Lecturer, *"Introduction to Design Thinking"*, Yuseong-gu Startup Cluster Academy, Daejeon, Korea — Jan, 2019

ACADEMIC SERVICES

Program Committee Member, ACM Participatory Design Conference (PDC)	2026
Reviewer, Design Convergence Study [KCI]	2026
Reviewer, Archives of Design Research (AoDR) [KCI]	2026
Reviewer, HCI International (HCII)	2026
Reviewer, International Association of Societies of Design Research (IASDR)	2025
Coordinator, Social Impact Special Interest Group, Korean Society of Design Science (KSDS)	2024-Present

PROFESSIONAL & POLICY SERVICES

Ongoing Roles

대전시청 인구소멸 이사**..**
대전 중구 상권활성화 이사**..**

Board Member,
Committee on Local Extinction Response & Regional Innovation 2026-2027
Korean Association for Local Government Studies (KALGS)

Advisory Committee Member, Local Branding Revitalization Initiative 2025-2026
Boeun County Government

Mentor, 2025 Youth Village Support Program 2025
Ministry of the Interior & Safety, Korea

Member, Social Economy Advisory Committee 2024 - 2026
Seo-gu District Office, Daejeon Metropolitan City

Mentor, Deep Tech Startup IR Program 2018 - 2025
Startup KAIST, KAIST Center for Entrepreneurship

Consultant, Local Creator Support Program 2023
Daejeon Metropolitan City & Ministry of SMEs and Startups, Korea

Consultant, Local Creator Support Program 2023
Daejeon Center for Creative Economy & Innovation

One-time Roles

Evaluator, Theme Selection for Citizen Proposal Program “Public is” Apr, 2025
Daejeon Metropolitan Government

Evaluator, Community Problem-Solving Enterprise Selection Apr, 2025
Seo-gu District Office, Daejeon

Mentor, New Business Startup Academy (신사업창업사관학교) Nov, 2023
Daejeon Center for Creative Economy & Innovation

Advisor, Urban Competitiveness Index Framework for Daejeon Nov, 2023
Daejeon Sejong Research Institute

Moderator, Local Creator Networking & Forum "Local Festa" Oct, 2023
Sejong Center for Creative Economy & Innovation

Keynote Moderator, Ulsan International Impact Conference (UIIC) Sep, 2023
Ministry of the Interior & Safety, Korea

Evaluator, Local Contents Town Project May, 2023
Sejong Center for Creative Economy & Innovation

Advisor, Digital Strategies for Vocational Education and Training Dec, 2022
Korea Research Institute for Vocational Education & Training (KRIVET)

AWARDS & HONORS

Research Paper Excellence Award, Korea Society of Design Science Nov, 2024

Grand Prize, BK21 Program Overseas Visit Essay Contest for Graduate Students, KAIST Office of Research Affairs Mar, 2024

Grand Prize, Ph.D. Colloquium Research Day, Department of Industrial Design, KAIST Nov, 2023

Grand Prize, Heuristic Competition, Shinhan Corp-KAIST Investment Challenge, Department of System Engineering, KAIST Aug, 2021

EXHIBITIONS

Dreaming Hen Nov, 2025
KIID International Invitation Exhibition, Yong-In, Korea

Bright Learning School Desk Dec, 2023
KIID International Invitation Exhibition, Seoul, Korea

Nerd Stool Project Dec, 2023
Daejeon Social Innovation Center Showcase, Daejeon, Korea

Metaphoric Forest Oct, 2023
Live Like a Local: Local Creator Showcase, Sejong, *Korea*

Local Hero Nurturing Game: Collaborative Policy Ideation Platform Dec, 2022
Inventive Minds and Ideas: Living in the Future, Seoul, Korea

'Neb' Map: Unwilling and Impolite 'Yes' in Interaction between Kakaotalk Users Nov, 2019
Neologism Archive Exhibition, Seoul, Korea

Fail Puzzle Display: A Participatory Archive of Everyday Failures Sep, 2019
Fail Expo, Ministry of the Interior & Safety, Seoul, Korea

CERTIFICATION

Service and Experience Design Engineer Certificate Dec. 2022
- National Technical Qualification, Korea Institute of Design Promotion (KIDP)

MEDIA COVERAGE (Title translated into English)

Science People: Move Toward the Problems You Want to Solve Science Donga
Mar, 2026

When Churches, Cafés, and Restaurants Come Together: Rethinking the "Church Dilemma" Through Playful Collaboration
https://www.kmib.co.kr/article/view.asp?arcid=0029155019
Kookmin Ilbo
Dec 23, 2025

Not Seoul, but Daejeon: A New Experiment Led by Young People Who Choose to Stay
https://www.nocutnews.co.kr/news/6443399
NoCut News
Dec 15, 2025

Eunji Woo, Moves Between Local Researcher and Practitioner
https://id.kaist.ac.kr/article/086f9f2e-5dfe-4563-a89f-7c506a3ba370
ID KAIST
April 11, 2023

Young Entrepreneurs Team Up with Neighbors: What's Happening in Daejeon's Eo-Gung-dong?
https://www.hani.co.kr/arti/area/chungcheong/1087342.html
The Hankyoreh
April 11, 2023

[Local Science Talents] 36. Eunji Woo, Researcher at KAIST Designize Lab
https://www.kyongbuk.co.kr/news/articleView.html?idxno=2128443&sc_serial_code=SRN345
Gyeongbuk Ilbo
April 5, 2023

Daejeon's Yuseong Neighborhood Program: The People Making Joyful Eo-Gung-dong
https://times.kaist.ac.kr/news/articleView.html?idxno=21239
KAIST Times
April 3, 2023

Eunji Woo: Navigating Between Local Researcher and Community Player
https://www.belocal.kr/news/articleView.html?idxno=2243373
BeLocal
March 1, 2023